



1. Force Majeure Description

Update: December 06, 2022

- 1. ?
- 2. ? General information and description
- 3. ? Detailed description and handling
- 4. ✓ Which cases do we consider FM?
- 5. ✓ What are the options provided to passengers?
- 6. ✓ Handling step by step
- 7. ✓ What fees do we apply?
- 8. ✓ Bulk email sent through Covid19 period
- 9. ✓ What should we pay attention to?

Step 1 - Starting point

Question

No linked steps

Summary: Force Majeure events affect flight operations. Airlines update policies regularly; SC team manages FM cases. Options include full refunds, rebooking, or vouchers/open tickets. Full refunds have conditions; rebooking is usually free. Vouchers retain ticket value; EMDs are for future ticketing. Guidelines cover rebooking, refunds, and handling complaints. Bulk emails during Covid-19 offered alternatives to refunds. Specific instructions for ticket validity, changes, and documentation are provided.

Reading time: 36 minutes

1. General information and description	Step 2
2. Detailed description and handling	Step 3

Step 2

Question

Parent step: 1

General information and description	
1. Which cases do we consider FM?	Step 4
2. What are the options provided to passengers?	Step 5

Step 3

Question

Parent step: 1

Detailed description and handling

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|--------|
| 1. Handling step by step | Step 6 |
| 2. What fees do we apply? | Step 7 |
| 3. Bulk emails sent through covid19 | Step 8 |
| 4. What should we pay attention to? | Step 9 |

Step 4

Solution

Parent step: 2

Which cases do we consider FM?

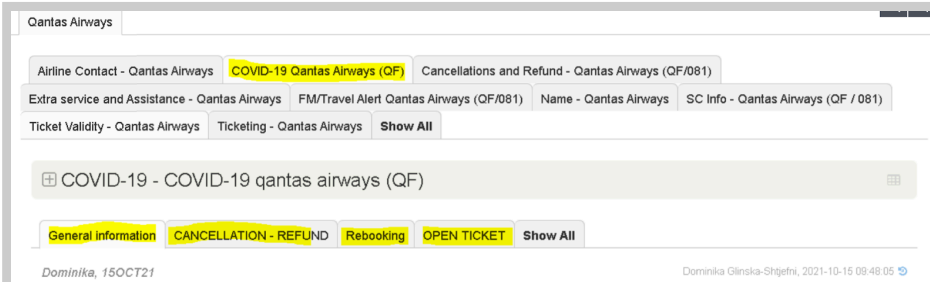
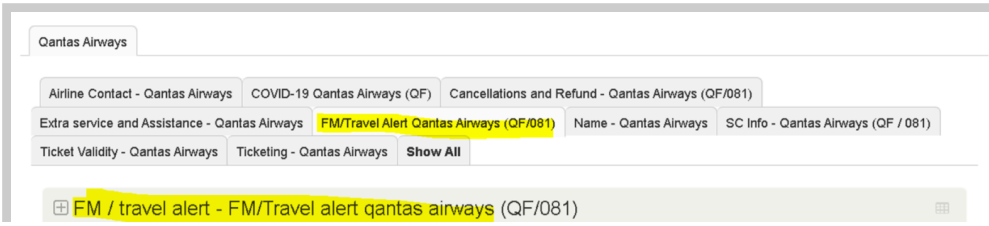
Force Majeure (FM) occurs when an extraordinary event or circumstance beyond the control of the parties, such as the pandemic of COVID-19, massive strikes, weather conditions, bankruptcy, or political situations, prevents an airline from operating flights.

In such cases, airline companies usually provide exceptional policies and guidelines that we have to follow, and these might change constantly. Thus, we should check our Edvin documents regularly to see any new updates that might have been published. These cases are handled by all FL agents.

The status of the flight may be confirmed (HK) and/or affected by involuntary cancellation/schedule change (UN/TK). If there is an FM policy for handling a specific ticket, you may handle it further and offer passengers all possible alternatives. Whenever you see UN, UN/TK, TK, or TK/HX, we should consider these as SCs, and the SC team will handle them as well.

Since there is no possibility of separating FM and SC cases by looking at the status of the tickets, we have decided that the SC team will check the COVID-19 and FM TA policy as well, and if there is no restriction from the airline side, then agents will handle it as an SC case.

When an FM situation occurs, the FM team is responsible for creating and updating the related Edvin document.

Covid19 Edvin document	policies for all Covid19 pandemic situations 
FM/Travel Alert Edvin document	policies for any other alert such as strikes, weather conditions, political situations etc. 

If you receive new information, if there is an error in the Edvin-related documents, or if you need any clarification or there are any uncertainties regarding the policies, do not hesitate to contact the FM team on Slack at #force-majeure or email forcemajeure@etraveligroup.com. If there is no information for the FM situation, put the PNR in the Support Queue, and the Support team will contact the FM team.

If the order is affected by a Force Majeure situation, involuntary service fees apply. For details on our fee structure for FM rebookings, check [here](#) and for FM cancellation check [here](#).
B.com and Platinum customers **are excluded from these fees**.

Follow strictly the guidelines provided in each travel alert and offer the options stated. Be careful that all the conditions need to be met to be eligible for a refund/rebooking/open ticket.

Bankruptcy of an airline is also considered a FM/Travel alert situation. Whenever a bankruptcy occurs, Edvin documents are updated accordingly with the possible options, if there are any, and a blog post in the Travel alerts folder—**Bankruptcies**—is published.

Flight cancelled and there is no policy in Edvin Docs

Customer claiming flight was cancelled but there is no related Force Majeure TA

Customer claiming flight was cancelled, its not visible in our booking systems and there is no known FM reason behind it:

- If customer wants **rebooking** to another flight: refer to Airline or inform about our applicable involuntary service fees.
- If they need our assistance, place the order on respective Support Queue in order for the Support agent to contact the airline and find out if the flight was indeed cancelled. Support agent will inform passenger about the outcome and any applicable additional charges from the airline (if applicable).
- If customer wants **refund** claiming flight was cancelled, follow below steps:

Active pnr:

- Check ticket status.
- If status is open, put on respective Support Queue with information from customer that flight was cancelled and that we need to get an authorization for refund from the airline.

Pnr no longer active:

- Find ticket numbers in Edvin. Open up ticket(s) in GDS. (Command TWD/TKT... or WETR*T...) Check ticket status.
- If status is open, put on respective Support Queue with information from customer that flight was cancelled and that we need to get an authorization for refund from the airline.

Step 5

Solution

Parent step: 2

What are the options provided to passengers?

The options always depend on the airline company the customer is traveling with. This is why we have to carefully read the relevant Edvin Documents (Covid19, FM/Travel alert)

Options provided to passengers

Full refund	Always check in which cases the airline allows full refund and if requires the seats to be cancelled before the departure. Make sure to check Important information on handling orders with inactive segments .
Rebooking	In almost all cases, the airline companies offer a free of charge rebooking (change penalty is waived)
Voucher or Open ticket	The passenger keeps the amount paid for the ticket in a so-called “voucher” or open ticket . This gives the opportunity to the customer to, later on, use this amount for a future trip with this same airline company.

What is the difference between a voucher and an open ticket?

Open ticket

Is when we leave the PNR “alive” with a ghost line, so the customer can use the same ticket later on. Thus, for an open ticket, the segments should be canceled, and we keep only the ghost line. Then, when the customer decides to travel and calls back, we add the new segments in the same PNR and reissue the old ticket. Sometimes we do refer to the open ticket as a voucher, but keep in mind that if we are the ones who will reissue the ticket, it is basically the open ticket option that is being used.

Voucher

We would say that an option the airline offers is an EMD issued with the value of the ticket's cost. We will exchange tickets for EMDs, and also EMDs for tickets when the time comes.

What is the difference between a voucher and an EMD?

Voucher is like a "coupon" that the airline issues (either by the helpdesk or via the airline's website), and passengers can redeem it by buying a new ticket, ancillaries, or other services directly from the airline.

Whereas **EMD**, we have when our ticketing team takes a ticket and exchanges its value for a document (EMD) in order to use its value in the future. This means that the customer gets a new EMD ticket number, which contains the original ticket's value.

At a later point, when the customer comes back to us with the future flights they want, we take this EMD and reissue it into an electronic ticket.

This is the difference with the open ticket, as the latter is actually the customer's ticket. We have removed the segments and added a ghost line to be able to reissue the ticket at a later stage.

Step 6

 Solution

Parent step: 3

Handling step by step

> Refund requests

Steps

- Check Covid19 or FM/Travel alert docs. If flights are affected by SC and the Covid19,FM/Travel alert docs allow you to follow SC policy, you can follow SC docs. Otherwise, follow the exceptional policies for the appropriate category.
- Check the status of the ticket. (Open, exchanged, suspended)
- Check when the ticket was issued and in which office/iata
- Check the itinerary and the date of travel
- Check the policy applicable in related docs **and if the tkt meets the criterias.**
- Inform the customer accordingly and do not forget to mention our applicable involuntary service fee, which will be deducted (for any exceptions check [here](#)).
- Inform also on the products that are non-refundable from our side.
- If the customer confirms and no authorization from the airline is needed, proceed through Modify order by filling in all the required information.
- Insert remark/OSI if required, save it, then cancel the segments that won't be used and at the end add a ghost line.
- Confirm to the customer the reservation is cancelled and that we cannot give a specific deadline within which the refund will be received.
- Send the related CXL confirmation template from Edvin

If a customer comes to us after they have accepted to have an open ticket, but they are now asking for a refund, you should check if this is still possible as per the information we have in Edwin Covid-19 Refund and Open tkt docs.

In case you have a customer that has an order with both regular (GDS) booking and LCC booking and it is the same airline company operating the flights on both, you should assist the customer for both bookings, charging the applicable involuntary service fee only once. Do NOT refer the customer to the Low-Cost Carrier, **but rather check in the LCC docs how to handle requests for this airline** (call, email, portal, manage my booking), in order to assist the customer accordingly.

Be very attentive when checking the status of the ticket and make sure to check in the history of the PNR when a change/suspension has been made, so that you know how to correctly handle the request. In cases when a ticket is exchanged by the airline company and the customer requests a refund, we will place it on Support Queue to contact the airline, and only then we can clarify whether the refund is possible or not. The case should not be placed on the Refund Queue via Modify Order. Exceptions apply for SU, UX, check relevant Covid 19 / CXL docs and [Shelf page](#) for proper procedure.

> Rebooking

1). Manual rebooking; [Here](#)

2). Rebooking due to Covid test positive;

Important info

1. The below instructions apply for:

-
- **KQ, VT, TK & WB** but only in cases of Covid Test positive.
- **VA** for both scenarios (COVID-19 diagnosed + close contact with COVID-19 patient), but only for domestic flights and for rebooking with fare/tax difference covered by the passenger

ATTENTION: Please do not use the following words in errands: Medical doc, Covid-19 test positive, etc. Use Covid GDPR instead.

For outsourcing: The cases need to be escalated through ServiceDesk under the category 'GDPR'

1. Covid Test positive (with medical certificate proof). ALL DOCUMENTS NEED TO BE TRANSLATED IN ENGLISH

2. Contact with Covid-19 patient which prevent them from traveling due to quarantine required (with a certificate that proves the exposure to Covid-19 patient)

The below process needs to be followed:

For FL phone agent:

1. Inform PAX about our involuntary service fee & redirect him/her to attach the medical certificate through our website at: <https://www.etraveligroup.com/medcert/>
2. If PAX is not able to attach the certificate on the spot then inform them to call us again when it is done. Always ask them to provide the e-mail address that was registered.
3. Ask PAX for the dates and the specific flights they want to rebook.
4. Check the availability of the new flights. If not available, ask for new dates.
5. Place on the support queue by providing all the necessary information. (medical certificate needs approval and the requested dates and flights)

For support agent:

1. Check with TL if the medical certificate is approved.

For TL:

1. Search in e-track and check the medical certificate.
2. Register Errand with DOC approval/denial and the e-track number.

(In order to approve or deny a DOC, always check the COVID-19 Edvin tab and the respective airline's policy for the DOC requirements)

3. Change status in the Support Queue to "needs to be handled" and move the email to the etrack category: **8.7 Stored Medical Certificate GDPR**, while it is open.
4. After moving the email to category **8.7 Stored Medical Certificate GDPR**, close etrack.

For support agent:

1. Check the TL's errand

If approved, send PL to pax with the respective involuntary service fee and any fare difference (always check the Edvin docs FM rebooking policy)

If denied, then inform PAX according to other FM options or to reach out to us again for rebooking according to fare rules.

➤ Open ticket

➤ Detailed guideline for Open ticket

➤ What is an Open Ticket?

With the definition 'Open Ticket', we describe a PNR for which we issued ticket(s), but after the customer's request, we have removed the segments (usually prior to departure) in order to rebook the ticket in the future, within a specific time limit in the validity that the airline sets in their guidelines (always check FM/Travel Alerts/COVID-19 policies). To keep the booking active, we put in a ghost line and remove the flight segments so we will be able to use it later.

Keep in mind that what we present to the customer as a "voucher," in reality, is called an Open Ticket because the ticket remains "open" for future use.

We can also issue EMD vouchers in GDS if the airline allows it, and you get a number similar to a ticket number (e.g., like a baggage EMD number). Then the customer comes back with this EMD number, and we reissue it into an electronic ticket number (a normal e-ticket). For further information, check below EMD/Voucher.

➤ How to revert the ticket "Open Ticket"?

Check the FM/ Travel Alerts/ COVID-19 policies in the Edvin Docs and make sure the airline offers the Open Ticket option as alternative for that specific booking. Delete flight segments and insert retention line (ghost-line).

➤ Rebook an Open Ticket

Usually the ticket remains valid for 1 year from date of its issuance. Check FM/ Travel Alerts/ COVID-19 policies pages for any exception/extensions. If on those pages the phrase stated is "within ticket validity", then you check the specific tickets validity as per the airlines rules.

-Add information in Edvin notes, follow Register Errand- Force Majeure- Open Ticket.

Step by step (the day the passenger contacts us and wants to re-book):

- Read TA (What can we re-book to? The same booking class? Should we take in the diff? Is there any discount? Etc.)
- Open the original PNR to see if it is still active otherwise create a new PNR on the same office ID the original ticket was issued (This applies both for our primary and consolidator office IDs).
- Add new flights
- Run ATC/WFRF Eg AMA: FXO/R,UP/S2-4 Sabre: Smartkey

- If this does not work add new flights and price the new segments manually.
- If you are unable to price the new segments, check the issue with your FL Coordinators or place the request on Support with clear errand notes.
- Run the rebooking wizard selecting the Force Majeure scenario and insert all the relevant information.
- Send PL for the fare/ tax difference plus the respective involuntary service fee (valid 2 hours & max to 15.30).
- Only after the customer pays us, we can proceed with saving the segments and sending it to ticketing through the rebooking wizard for reissue.

PING It is a great opportunity to sell the Flexible ticket or travel insurance when the passenger gets back and wants to change their ticket.

For Support or agent who handles PL:

Use the rebooking wizard (Force Majeure scenario) to send the case to the ticketing queue.

➤ When customer contacts us to leave the ticket open

- *Insert Ghostline in the pnr*
- *Errands in EDVIN / Template in errand*

Option for Open Tickets will be available under Force Majeure. Also, a template in errand called Open ticket should be registered when you are converting a ticket to "OPEN".

The screenshot shows the 'Register Errand' form in a travel system. The form has the following fields:

- Channel:** A dropdown menu with 'Select Channel' as the placeholder.
- Category:** A dropdown menu with 'Select Category' as the placeholder.
- Type:** A dropdown menu with 'Select Type' as the placeholder.
- Action:** A dropdown menu with 'Select Action' as the placeholder.
- Templates:** A dropdown menu with a list of templates.

The list of templates includes:

- Rebooking due to FM
- New ticket with Voucher/FM
- Open ticket** (highlighted)
- To Support
- CANCELLATION
- LCC
- Refund add on product
- GDS Cancellation
- B.com GDS cancellation
- REBOOKING

At the bottom of the form, there are two buttons: 'Add (Alt + Enter)' and 'Cancel'.

- *Change order option*

There will be an option to change order due to open ticket process

Change Order

Change Reason

Select

|

Against Ticket Rules - change

Bankruptcy - change

COVID-19 Open ticket/voucher

Cancel part of order

Connection guarantee

Flexible ticket

Force Majeure - change

Infant booked

Namechange or namecorrection - change

New ticket

Optimization

Rebooked before ticketing

Schedule Change - change

Split PNR

Change Order

- *EDVIN Templates*

There will be templates available in EDVIN for open ticket under Rebooking FL

Send Email - Select template



📁 Covid-19

- 📄 Covid-19 LCC CXL confirmation 10.L
- 📄 Covid-19 - FM/SC first alternative 1.L
- 📄 Covid-19 - Rebooking 3.L
- 📄 Covid-19 - CXL confirmation 5.L
- 📄 Covid-19 - LCC CXL request 7.L
- 📄 Covid-19 Feedback 8.L
- 📄 Voucher confirmation 9.L
- 📄 CXL request - too late for refund 40.A
- 📄 Open TKT 81.D
- 📄 Booking.com Open TKT 81.D

📁 CXL Request - FL

📁 CXL Confirmation - FL Force Majeure

📁 CXL Confirmation - FL Void/24h

📁 CXL Confirmation - FL rules

📁 CXL Confirmation - FL CXL protection

📁 Rebooking - FL

📁 Schedule Change

📁 Ancillary

📁 Farelogix

📁 Backoffice

📁 Customer Relations



Select a template from the menu to the left

Send Email (Alt + Enter)

Cancel

Send Email - Enter user input - Open TKT 81.D

Validity

Date of issue

Airline fee

Handling fee

Dear Sir/Madam,

In reference to our call please find the information below.

Your tickets have been converted into open tickets and can be changed to a specific date within from the date of issue .

When you change it to a specific date according to the rules of the airline, the cost will be RUB per ticket plus any fare difference. Our handling fee for this change will be RUB.

To change the time and date of your booking you need to contact us by telephone. That's where we handle rebooking/changes. Our opening hours as well as phone number can be found on our website, under "Contact."

Call us and we will look together at the possibility of rebooking your ticket.

Kind regards,
 Moemen E
 Trip

Back Use template

Send Email (Alt + Enter) Cancel

Order date in site time 2020-03-06 21:19:30 (RU)

Open Tickets - Process when the customer returns to us.

Actually, the process does not have many changes from the normal rebooking, when the customer contacts us back.

More info regarding Open ticket and Marks up

As you already know, we issue our tickets with a pricing that includes mark ups or mark downs (discounts).

With the open/voucher tickets project some customers that belong to the first category have received a voucher equal to the ticket price and not the purchase price.

This mark up shall not be refunded/compensated in any case and we need to inform the customer that this is the amount we got back from the airline.

We do not expect many cases in this scenario however it is useful to know this routine:

- We do not refund Mark-UP when customer contact us and ask about it, but instead communicate that this is the amount we got back from the airline.
- If the customer does not accept the above answer, then we need to escalate the case to TL/Manager. If customer still insists and threatens to move further with a claim then we need

to advise that they should contact CR.

- The case should be forwarded to CR, which makes a final decision on whether or not to refund the Mark-up and notify the customer accordingly.

Examples

1. Customer has a voucher for which they do not know the value (open ticket)

a. Voucher value/value customer can use to rebook;

According to normal rebooking routines (ie. based on fare)

- Do not cover the diff in case of positive markup (inform the customer that this is the amount we got back from the airline)
- Charge the respective involuntary service fee

2. Customer has a voucher for which they know the value (EMDs and vouchers issued by airline)

a. Voucher is of lower value than what they initially paid

- Charge **the respective involuntary service fee**
- If the customer wants the difference refunded inform the customer that this is the amount we got back from the airline (ie do NOT refund the diff)

b. Voucher is of higher value than what they initially paid

- Charge **the respective involuntary service fee**

3. Customer has made the rebooking directly with the airline, and the value of the voucher was lower than what they initially paid, and they reach out to us for refund of the difference

- Do NOT refund the diff. Inform the customer that this is the amount we got back from the airline.
- If customer calls to rebook with us, charge **the respective involuntary service fee**

If you see in Edvin the below:

	Created	Department	Title	Note
	2020-04-06 21:24 System Internal		CHANGED	voucher_option_accepted for PNR OJW5F

It means the customer has already accepted the open ticket option we sent to him via bulk email. In this case, seats should be automatically cancelled. Although, always check GDS to confirm if they are cancelled indeed.

If a passenger requests open ticket follow the below:

Steps:

-
- Check the respective airline Covid 19 docs.
- Be careful with the validity. Check respective columns in the Covid 19 docs and the Ticket Validity docs.
- Check the fare rules, if there is any restriction for the seasonality of the specific ticket.
- Was the customer a no-show, if yes, check carefully which penalties we should apply
- Add the ghostline in GDS
- If open ticket is an option, then you can proceed with cancelling the tickets in GDS, if they are not cancelled already
- Register an errand in Edvin, by choosing "Template"
- Send a confirmation email from Edvin, use template 81.D
- Select Change button in Edvin with Reason: Open ticket

Fake reissue

Due to the Covid-19 pandemic extending the ticket validity has been vital so as to give customers more time to rebook and travel.

Some airlines have enabled this option to be automatic or via EMD/Voucher options. Some other airlines have set up "manual" procedures to extend one ticket's validity by doing a "fake" reissue. This "fake" reissue gives the customer 1 year from the "fake" reissue date or more (depending on each policy) to rebook and travel

Currently, we have the following 3 airlines with such published procedures: **FB, FJ, VT**

If more airlines include this process to their policies, we will update relevant covid -19 tabs

In case of an open ticket where passenger calls back to ask for more time or want to opt for the open ticket option but won't travel within the existing ticket validity, follow the below steps

1. Check the open ticket section of the Covid-19 tab of the airline to detect if the specific ticket is eligible for the fake reissue (may depend on the original issue, travel date, route, etc).
2. If eligible, FL/Support agent should find and book the "fake" segments for the reissue and/or create a new pnr if needed (in case of purged pnr).
3. In case there is a charge for the fake reissue, FL should charge pax only the airlines fee (as our service fee will be charged later on with the rebooking of the open tkt) by selecting: Airline Cost - Rebooking / New Ticket (GDS) NOT Flexible Ticket. If there is no charge for it by the airline, then proceed to step 4.
4. No need to price the new "fake" segments" . FL/Support agent should register errand by selecting the edvin template for ticketing:

TICKETING

TKT info ATC reissue (incl. FM) (Amadeus/Sabre...

TKT info SC INVOL reissue (NOT FM) (Amadeus...

TKT info reissue (incl. FM) (Amadeus/Sabre/Gall...

TKT info name change (Amadeus/Sabre/Galileo)

TKT info new ticket (Amadeus/Sabre/Galileo)

made

5. FL/Support agent should fill in the ticketing template clearly mentioning what reissue we need as per below example:

*** ATT TICKETING *** PNR: XXXXX >>

Customer contact: MR JOE

Check-list OK: YES

Force Majeure: YES

FLEXTKT: NO

Command used: none due to manual fake reissue to extend tkt validity

Airline Penalty: -

No show fee: -

Fare diff: -

Tax diff: 5eur per pax as CP tax

Fare basis: -

ENDOM/WAIVER: FB validity extension

Baggage Upsell/EMD: -

Ancillaries: -

OTHER INFO: this is a fake manual reissue so as to extend tkts validity

///REMEMBER TO PLACE ON REISSUE QUEUE IN EDVIN///

6. FL/Support agent queues the order to ticketing queue by selecting "Involuntary Changes" ticketing queue and writing "PNRNUMBER//OFFICEID//MANUAL FAKE REISSUE TO EXTEND TKT VALIDITY":

The screenshot shows a web application titled "Queue Place". At the top, there are several tabs: Fraud, Products, Refund, SC, Social Media Support, Support ATH, Support B2B, Support CNX, Support ETG BOM, Support UPA, UPA TKT, Support WNS, **BOM TKT** (highlighted in yellow), and CR-UPA. Below these tabs, there are buttons for Payments, Technical, and Show All. The main section is titled "BOM TKT" and contains a list of options with checkboxes and corresponding buttons on the right:

- ☐ Ancillary post sales (button: Ancillary post sales)
- ☐ CONF - only to be used by CONF-Team (button: CONF - only to be used by CONF-Team)
- ☐ EMD voucher issuance (place pnr's where we need to issue EMD vouchers) (button: EMD voucher issuance)
- ☒ **Involuntary changes** (Add short info: PNR/area/freetext in regards of sc reissues/ force majeure reissues) (button: Involuntary changes)
- ☐ Voluntary changes (With provider cost) (button: Voluntary changes)
- ☐ Voluntary changes FOC (Free of charge (FOC by carrier)) (button: Voluntary changes FOC)

At the bottom, there is a section titled "Order Note/Queue Action Message" with a text input field containing the text: XXXXX/OFFICED/MANUAL FAKE REISSUE TO EXTEND TKT VALIDITY

7. After the reissue is done, the ticketing agent should remove the "fake" segments instantly and send the email confirmation to customers for open tkt with the new validity by selecting the Edwin template for Covid -19 open ticket template.

> EMD/VOUCHER

A Voucher or an EMD for future travel is when we and/or the airline take an electronic ticket and exchange its value for an EMD or a Voucher in order to use the value in the future. As per the current Covid-19 guidelines, there are 3 scenarios when opting for a Voucher/EMD option:

- Issuance of an EMD ticket number.
- Issuance of the Voucher by the airline via the ETG interference.
- Issuance of the Voucher directly with the airline by passenger themselves.

Some airlines may belong to more than 1 category as different offices of the same airline may have different policies/capabilities. Some airlines may require slightly different actions due to the complexity of these Covid 19 EMD/Vouchers. So always check carefully the relevant Covid 19 TAs.

For full instructions please refer to the menu options below

➤ Issuance of an EMD ticket number

An EMD voucher is when we take an electronic ticket and exchange its value for an EMD in order to use this value in the future. This means that the customer will get a new EMD ticket number (for example like a baggage EMD) that contains his original ticket's value.

For example, if we have an e-ticket 123-0000000000 with a value of 100 EUR, we exchange this e-ticket into an EMD number 123-9999999999 which contains a value of 100 EUR.

At a later point, when the customer comes back to us, we take the EMD 123-9999999999 which holds 100 EUR in it and reissue it into an electronic ticket for the flights that the customer asks. Any fare/tax/penalty must be covered by the customer.

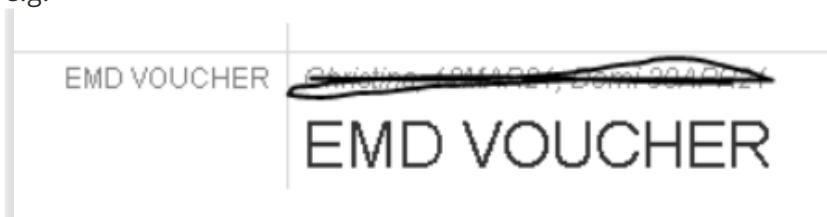
These EMDs are issued by our ticketing team. We have control over them and the rebooking of them can be done normally by us.

Step by step procedure - GDS PNRs:

The example below is for Amadeus, but the same selections exist in all GDS.

When the customer asks for an EMD voucher

1. Check the airline's policy in the Covid 19 docs:
e.g.



2. Cancel segments, insert ghostline and queue to ticketing via Edvin by using the below ticketing template errand and placing it in the proper queue:

Register Errand - TKT info issue EMD voucher (Amadeus/Sabre/Galileo)

Queue Place

Fraud

Products

Refund

SC

Social Media Support

Support ATH

Support B2B

Support CNX

Support ETC BOM

Support UPA

UPA TKT

Support WNS

BOM TKT

CR-UPA

Payments

Technical

Show All

BOM TKT

☐ Ancillary post sales	Add short info: PNR/Area/free text	Ancillary post sales
☐ CONF - only to be used by CONF-Team		CONF - only to be used by CONF-Team
☐ EMD voucher issuance	(place pnrs where we need to issue EMD vouchers)	EMD voucher issuance
☐ Involuntary changes	Add short info: PNR/area/freetext in regards of sc reissues/ force majeure reissues	Involuntary changes
☐ Voluntary changes	With provider cost	Voluntary changes
☐ Voluntary changes FOC	Free of charge (FOC by carrier)	Voluntary changes FOC

3. Send an email confirmation to the customer via Edwin:

Send Email - Select template

CC2C

Covid-19

- CXL request - Refund can be requested after TKT expiration
- Covid-19 - FM/SC first alternative 1.L
- Covid-19 - Rebooking 3.L
- Covid-19 - CXL confirmation 5.L
- Covid-19 - LCC CXL request 7.L
- Covid-19 Feedback 8.L
- Covid-19 Voucher confirmation 9.L
- Covid-19 LCC CXL confirmation 10.L
- Covid-19 - Rebooking of Solid/XCover/BRB/Manulife 13.L
- Covid-19 - Cancellation of Solid 14.L
- CXL request - too late for refund 40.A
- Open TKT 81.D
- Booking.com Open TKT 81.D

4. Change the status in Edvin to "COVID-19 Open ticket/voucher":

✖

Change Order

Change Reason

Select

Against Ticket Rules - change

Bankruptcy - change

COVID-19 Open ticket/voucher

Cancel part of order

Connection guarantee

Flexible ticket

Force Majeure - change

Infant booked

Namechange or namecorrection - change

New ticket

Optimization

Rebooked before ticketing

Schedule Change - change

Split PNR

Change Order

5. Once the voucher is issued by Ticketing, they will send a template to the customer:

DEAR SIR/MADAM,

HERE IS INFORMATION REGARDING YOUR VOUCHER TO USE FOR FUTURE TRAVEL WITH.

VOUCHER NUMBER: XX

VALUE EUR: XX

NAME: XX

LAST DATE TO USE: XX

KIND REGARDS,

KAROLINA Z

SUPERSAVER

Partially used tickets:

Ticketing will do the calculation of the EMD value. FL agents will not calculate such amounts at all.

FL agents will not provide any amounts to the customers, as the customers will be informed by the Ticketing department once the EMD voucher has been issued and sent to them.

Register Errand - TKT info issue EMD voucher (Amadeus/Sabre/Galileo)

When the customer comes back to use their EMD voucher

The customer will provide us with their EMD Voucher in order to reissue it for a new flight. Please follow the below steps.

1. Open the EMD Voucher and find its value

In Amadeus, you do **EWD/EMD123-456789012**

```
EMD-1571862838161      TYPE-S      SYS-1A  LOC-
INT-      FCI-1  1      POI-STO      DOI-16MAR20      IOI-80208774
PAX-      ADT
RFIC-D  FINANCIAL IMPACT
REMARKS-
CPN-1  RFISC-98B  QR STO      S-O      VALUE-6978
DESCRIPTION-TRANSPORTATION CREDIT VOUCHER
NON-INTERLINEABLE
PRESENT TO-
PRESENT AT-
SERVICE REMARKS-
FARE    R      SEK      6978
EXCH VAL SEK      6978      RFND VAL
TAX-
TOTAL      SEK      NO ADC
/FC
COMMISSION NEW      4.00
FO 157-3556508327STO15MAR20/80208774/157-3556508327-28
FP O/CCCA
FOID-
NON-ENDORSABLE
```

In Sabre, you do **WEMD*T1234567890123**

ELECTRONIC MISCELLANEOUS DOCUMENT RECORD

INV: CUST: PNR:
EMD:1571862838161 ISSUED:16MAR20 PCC:157996 IATA:80208774
NAME:GHEORGHE/FILIP MR FF:
NAME REF: TOUR ID:
FOP:

DOM/INT: SETTLEMENT AUTHORIZATION:
RFIC:D/FINANCIAL IMPACT

AIR EXTRA:TRANSPORTATION CREDIT VOUCHER
CPN:1 SVC CITIES:STO SVC DATE: QTY:1 STAT:OPEN

PRESENT TO:
PRESENT AT:

BASE AMT:SEK6978
TAX AMT:SEK

EMD TTL:SEKNO ADC
EQUIV AMT:

¥

2. Price the new itinerary

a) For Amadeus PNRs, keep the segments in the same PNR if it still opens, if not make a new PNR.

b) For Sabre and Galileo PNRs, ALWAYS make a new PNR in Amadeus. This is because it is not possible to reissue an EMD into an e-ticket in Sabre or Galileo.

Most probably the ticketing team has created an Amadeus PNR when they issued the EMD. If it still opens, you can also use this one.

3. Compare manually the total price of the new segments with the EMD value and collect any difference (we cannot see the fare and taxes separately on an EMD, therefore only check the total value)

4. Send the Payment Link to the customer with fare/tax difference, applicable penalty (if any) + respective involuntary service fee.

5. When paid, link the PNR in Edvin (only if you created a new PNR)

6. Use the rebooking Wizard (Force Majeure - Manual calculation scenario) to send the PNR to the ticketing queue. For more guidelines on how to insert the EMD voucher information for ticketing, please click [here](#).

➤ Issuance of the Voucher by the airline via ETG interference

The below steps are to be followed in cases where we as a travel agency must contact the airline or take action on the airline's website so our customer can receive their ticket value as a travel voucher for future use.

In cases where the voucher is issued by the airline after ETG has asked for it on behalf of the passenger, actions need to be taken by FL and NOT by BO. Such requests are NOT to be queued to BO for handling.

Steps to be followed:

1. Phone/Email agent reads the relevant Covid 19 docs and identifies if the voucher is eligible for the specific ticket and if we as an OTA need to request it to the airline on the passenger's behalf.
2. If yes, inform passengers about the rules of the voucher (validity, new travel, etc).
3. If pax agrees, put the case on support.
4. Support agents will either send the request to the airline per email or will fill out the necessary online voucher form, depending on each airline's policy.
5. If the voucher is to be sent to our support emails, then change the status of the support queue to awaiting. Once we receive the voucher to our support emails, then copy the airline's email and send it to the passenger's email address by creating a new email interaction with pax and remove the case from the support queue.
6. If the voucher is to be sent to the passenger's email directly by the airline, then remove it from the support queue. No need to send to pax any further email confirmation from our side, the email with the voucher from the airline will suffice.
7. Change the status of the order to "COVID-19 Open ticket/voucher" ONLY for orders with BA and AV tickets. The reason is that although the activation of the voucher is done via the airline, the rebooking is done by ETG. For the rest of the airlines under this category, do not change the status of the order. The rebooking will be done later on by the airline directly with pax, no further action is required from our side (exceptions may apply, check always the Covid 19 TAs carefully).

➤ Issuance of the Voucher directly with the airline by the passenger themselves

In cases where the voucher is to be issued by the airline without ETG needing to be involved, then refer the pax to the airline to handle it directly with the carrier. No further action is needed from our side. No changes to the Order status are to be done.

➤ Cancelled orders via a Refund Application but the RA was rejected by the airline

FOR COMPANY USE ONLY!

More information for cases where an order has been cancelled via a Refund Application but the RA was eventually rejected by the airline:

When the claims team determines that the RA got rejected even though the taskbar has been updated and the next task is the auto provider received payment.

- If according to the rejection reason we need to reclaim it through GDS or BSP then BO claims team will act accordingly
- If the rejection reason is not clear, then we need to escalate the case to YY or to the consolidator in order to inform us for the next actions.
- If the rejection reason is that an **EMD voucher** has been issued then we are ok to remove it from the RD.

If these series of checks have been made by BO, the order will have been removed from the RD before the passenger returns to FL asking for the progress of their request.

On the occasion that the order has not been removed from the RD, and only if FL can find that the RA is rejected and EMD voucher has been issued from us or by YY without escalating this case to BO, then they can also remove the order from the RD.

Step 7

Solution

Parent step: 3

What fees do we apply?

Applicable service fees are available under Involuntary Force Majeure related sections of the [Our service fee structure](#) decision tree along with the local currency [Pricelist](#)

For Exception in charging our standard service fees check [here](#)

For guidelines on the correct handling of complaints due to fee restructuring check [here](#).

For a detailed explanation of involuntary fees scenarios check [here](#).

Step 8

Solution

Parent step: 3

Bulk email sent through Covid19 period

Bulk emails were emails sent to passengers with the options provided by the airline (open ticket/ voucher instead of refund) at the beginning of the Covid19 period. For more info click [here](#).

What should we pay attention to?

> How to read covid19 and FM travel alert edvin document.

When you select one airline, you can see immediately what options are offered by the airline. The options that appear separately are "Refund", Rebooking, "Open tkt", "Voucher" (in the voucher you find more detailed info in regards to if we are talking about voucher or emd).

When reading the instructions for one route or one category (e.g. refund for UN flights), you need to read the whole line till the end for additional information. Do not stop at the second point, where you see "Yes" or "NO".

What each category means:

-
- **Office ID** - for which PCC the policy applies
- **Affected Travel or Tickets** - for which routes/itinerary the policy applies to
- **Refund** - is full refund an option?
- **SC date** - the date a schedule change happened (for the majority of the airlines, we state "no restrictions" as the date that a schedule change happened does not affect the policy)
- **Ticket issue date** - the date a ticket was issued
- **Travel date** - for which travel dates the policy applies. If there is at least one bound (OB or IB) of the ticket included in the travel date, then the policy applies, unless stated otherwise
- **Deadline** - is there a deadline to apply for refund/rebooking/open tkt/voucher/emd
- **Endorsement** - if there is something to be added in the ENDO BOX. Here we also put waiver codes to be inserted as remarks or OSI. Please note that when remark (OSI,SSR etc) is required from the airline, we should first add this and then delete the segments.
- **Refund Via** - from which system to process refunds
- **No show** - what happens in case of no-shows. You always need to check No show column.
- **SC Policy Apply** - In here we write "YES" or "NO" and it answers the question "Can we apply the Schedule Policy of the airline in case of UN-TK/UN?". Also for later dates than the ones mentioned in the Travel Alert, you follow the schedule change policy normally.
- **Additional Information** - Here we write any additional info that needs to be mentioned or how to apply the rebooking/open tkt/voucher/emd policy.
- **Rebooking, Rerouting** - YES or NO depending if it's allowed.
- **New Travel Dates** - dates for new travel to be done
- **Validity** - Check validity column and Ticket validity document.

Voucher/EMD Document

-
- In the third column, its written if we are talking about an EMD or a Voucher (the expand option always states voucher).

- The **deadline** refers to the deadline for the voucher to be issued.
- The **validity** refers till when the passenger can redeem the voucher/utilize the EMD.
- The **new travel dates** are for what dates pax can use the voucher/EMD on.
- In the **additional information** we include info for 3 things
 - a. how to apply for the voucher/ how to send it for EMD issuance;
 - b. how pax can use the voucher/EMD;
 - c. if the voucher/EMD is refundable or not, and how to proceed.

> Edvin automatic errands.

For all orders that we send out Bulk Emails and customers have accepted the option for Open Ticket, our system will automatically:

-
- Delete flight segments (Amadeus and Sabre)
- Add ghost line (Amadeus and Sabre)
- Add remarks in GDS (Amadeus and Sabre)

So, in Edvin you will see:

-
- Order errand that we have sent an email to the customer.
- Order errand when the customer has answered.
- If the customer approved the open ticket option, the order status will be updated to "Changed" (for the orders already cancelled, this option cannot be technically updated)

Therefore, If you come across a cancelled order where a note is added that the customer accepted the voucher option you can still inform and assist the customer with the open ticket according to set routines in Shelf for a specific airline. Just check if segments are cancelled and ghost line is added.

If you see that the customer accepted this option for open ticket and the order is already on Rebooking Support queue because of a previous request of the customer, we proceed as per his latest confirmation/request.

Sometimes you will also see a note in errands regarding a chargeback. When you are handling e-mails and see this information, you should not take any action (do not reply to customer), just close the email and add an errand writing down email number and the name of the person that contacted us, along with his request. The department checking chargebacks will handle it accordingly. If this happens during a call, we tell him that he has started a procedure with his bank and he can get details only through them from now on. We do not proceed with anything else if there is no further info in errands.

In case you see the below in Edvin notes:

	2020-04-27 10:07 System Internal	Voucher requested by customer on airline website.	Voucher issued by the airline for booking n
---	--	---	---

this means the customer has received a voucher that was issued by the airline company already. Regardless if he has replied to our Bulk email, the customer will need to contact the airline directly if he wants to use the voucher. Usually the segments will also be E/EXCH (exchanged).

➤ Important information in GDS.

For segments:

UN - cancelled

TK - alternative

UC - unavailable / cancelled

HX - no-show / cancelled *

*check in history when this segment appeared as HX. If it was before departure, it is probably cancelled/changed with the airline directly. If after, then it should be no-show.

For ticket status:

O - open tkt

E - exchanged (change might also be from the airline company)

S - suspended

To see when the FM/SC was done, you should check the history. You can use the commands **RHI** for Amadeus and ***HI** for Sabre.

Keep in mind that sometimes you might find PNRs without flight segments, specifically for orders with close departures. Those probably have been removed from our Ticketing department to avoid financial cost (ADMs).

You will probably see the following in GDS as an indication of the above (but sometimes it will be a regular ghostline):

eg. MIS 1A HK1 STO 04MAR-**SEGMENT REMOVED TO AVOID CHARGES**

You should still proceed as per the FM routines to verify Travel Alerts and assist passengers as per the directions we have there.

Whenever we have a ticket with status R/RFND (refunded) or S/SUSP (suspended) and there are no notes in Edvin confirming such an action was performed on our side, then probably the customer has proceeded with issuing a voucher directly with the airline company. Usually in those cases, there will be a remark in GDS, informing us that we should remove HX segments. So, if you come across such a case, make sure to remove the HX segments from the PNR.

To check the validity of the ticket, you should find the fare rules and then open the category **Maximum stay**. If nothing is mentioned there, then the validity should be 1 year from the date of ticket issuance. Also, make sure that you check the category **Seasonality** as there might be restrictions on which date the ticket can be used.

If you are to proceed with a change, fill in all the required information in the Register Errand "Template".

For cancellations, you do not have to place the refund on the queue in GDS, but rather it will be placed in Edvin queue after you go through the Modify order option.